

Hrvoje Grdic

Ruby on Rails & React Engineer · Tech Lead · Payments & Fintech

Zagreb, Croatia · Remote (EU & US overlap) · hrvoje.grdic1@gmail.com · back-slash.hr · github.com/caphg

Software engineer since 2011, contracting since 2014 through my own consultancy. I build and operate systems where money moves and mistakes are expensive: payment processing, billing, reconciliation and large-scale third-party integration. Usually the **single point of technical ownership**: architecture, implementation, AWS infrastructure, deploys and on-call, end to end.

EXPERIENCE

Backslash d.o.o., Founder & Principal Engineer

2014 – Present

Independent software consultancy in Zagreb, delivering long-running engagements for clients in payments, e-commerce and SaaS. Member of the **Toptal** network, whose screening process admits roughly the top 3% of applicants.

• RunPayments, Tech Lead

Mar 2023 – Present

Payment processing platform · Ruby on Rails, React, AWS

- Technical lead and sole owner of a production **payment processing platform**: data model, application, front end, infrastructure and release process.
- Engineered for correctness under money-movement constraints: **idempotent transaction handling**, reconciliation, auditable state transitions, and backwards-compatible, non-destructive migrations.
- Run the entire **AWS estate single-handedly** (networking, compute, RDS, caching, object storage, IAM, monitoring and alerting), with zero-downtime deploys and rehearsed rollback paths.
- Built the React operator and merchant surfaces on top of the Rails API.
- Operate a **multi-database** platform, PostgreSQL on RDS alongside Oracle, with the Oracle side containerised in Docker so tests run against a reproducible local instance.
- Single point of accountability for uptime: on-call, incident response, capacity planning and infrastructure cost.

• Hubstaff, Senior Engineer

Jan 2020 – Feb 2023

Time tracking, payroll & invoicing SaaS · Ruby on Rails, Vue.js

- Owned the integrations platform: roughly **30 third-party integrations** across project management, accounting and payment providers, keeping time-tracking, project and payment data continuously in sync.
- Designed sync to survive the real world: rate limits, partial failures, backfills, webhook-plus-polling hybrids, and constant upstream API drift across dozens of independent vendors.
- Worked across the payroll and invoicing paths, where sync errors surface directly as incorrect payments.
- Full-stack delivery in Rails and Vue.js on a large, long-lived production codebase.

• Capitalize, Founding Engineer (sole)

2018 – 2019

Fintech startup · Ruby on Rails, React

- Sole engineer alongside the founder. Built the **entire product from zero**: architecture, backend, front end, infrastructure and deployment.
- The product I built solo carried the company through its **\$2M Series A**; an in-house team was hired after the raise, and the product remains in operation today.
- Eighteen months of direct founder collaboration: scoping, prioritisation, and shipping to investor-facing deadlines without a team to fall back on.

SELECTED CLIENT ENGAGEMENTS

BigCommerce

Real-time Rails sync engine holding items, orders, customers and payments consistent across **BigCommerce, Square and Clover**. Background-job architecture built around ordering guarantees, retries and idempotency.

Digital signage network	Rails platform for an advertising company running screens across hotels and venues, covering central ad management and per-display playlist scheduling. Held a contractual 7-minute publishing deadline on large multi-page playlists by sharding the workload and fanning it out across AWS Lambda , backed by Redis caching. Packaged Lambda code as Docker images and split live traffic across EC2 and Lambda targets behind an ALB with weighted routing .
Clover	Android applications for the Clover merchant device ecosystem, including native bridges between Android and Clover's SDK, and hybrid Ionic / Cordova integrations.
US sandwich franchise	Customer ordering application with deep Clover integration: kitchen and customer-facing receipt printing, plus a loyalty programme. <i>Chain name under NDA</i> .
Western Union	Node.js and Android development for customer-operated self-service terminals.
Philips	Large JavaScript ordering application for an apparel catalogue.
Boating in Boston	Ruby on Rails and Angular.js web application.
Griot	React Native and Android application built around real-time voice and video calling between field workers and remote support.
Also	20+ further engagements across payments, e-commerce and SaaS since 2014.

OPEN SOURCE

treble-ruby	Author of the official Treble SDK for Ruby : Rails middleware that reports API requests, responses and errors to Treble's API monitoring platform, while keeping sensitive fields out of what leaves the application. MIT licensed · github.com/Treble/treble-ruby
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EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Ericsson, Software Engineer Telecommunications · Java	2013 – 2014
Java engineering at one of the world's largest telecommunications equipment makers.	
PBZ (Privredna banka Zagreb), Software Engineer Banking · Java	2012 – 2013
In-house Java engineering at one of Croatia's largest banks, and the start of a career-long specialisation in financial software.	
Iskon Internet, Software Engineer Internet service provider · Hrvatski Telekom group	2011 – 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

BACKEND	Ruby on Rails, Ruby, Python (Django), Node.js, REST & webhook API design, background-job architecture
FRONTEND	React, Vue.js, Angular.js, JavaScript
MOBILE	Android (Java), React Native, Clover SDK & native bridges, Ionic, Cordova
INFRASTRUCTURE	AWS (EC2, Lambda, RDS, S3, VPC, IAM, CloudWatch, ALB), Heroku, Vercel
DEPLOYMENT	Docker, containerised services and Lambda images, ALB weighted routing, autoscaling, zero-downtime releases, monitoring & on-call
TESTING & PERF	RSpec, Jest, Faker, DatabaseCleaner, performance profiling, memory and query analysis, production debugging
DATA & CACHING	PostgreSQL (RDS), Oracle, MySQL, Redis, Memcached, queueing and job pipelines
DOMAIN	Payment processing, billing & invoicing, reconciliation, idempotency & consistency, third-party integration at scale

EDUCATION

MSc, Computing University of Zagreb, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing (FER)	Zagreb, Croatia
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